

SAURABH AWASTHI

Network Specialist | Network Operations Center (NOC) Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Network Specialist and NOC Engineer with 4+ years of hands-on experience supporting enterprise network infrastructure for multiple global clients from a 24x7 Global Network Operations Center (GNOC). Strong across Cisco routing and switching, Cisco Meraki, FortiGate and Palo Alto firewalls, Cisco Wireless LAN Controller (WLC), Virtual Private Network (VPN) and Software-Defined Wide Area Network (SD-WAN), with solid command of OSPF, BGP, VLAN, STP, DHCP and DNS. Experienced in advanced Layer 2 and Layer 3 troubleshooting, major incident management, root cause analysis (RCA) and ITIL-based change management. Reduced repeat incidents by 40% and cross-team resolution times by 30% across 50+ multi-site enterprise locations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Network Engineering, Network Operations Center (NOC), Cisco Routing and Switching, Cisco Meraki, FortiGate Firewall Administration, Palo Alto Firewalls, Cisco Wireless LAN Controller (WLC), VPN, SD-WAN, OSPF, BGP, VLAN, STP, DHCP, DNS, TCP/IP, Incident Management, Major Incident Management, Problem Management, Change Management, Root Cause Analysis (RCA), ITIL Framework, Network Monitoring, ServiceNow, Network Documentation, Capacity Planning, SLA Management, Team Mentoring

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Routing and Switching: Cisco, HP, Dell, Ruckus switches and routers, enterprise configuration, migration and troubleshooting

Wireless: Cisco Wireless LAN Controller (WLC), Cisco Meraki, Access Point configuration, monitoring and troubleshooting

Network Security: FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer, Palo Alto, firewall policies, NAT, IPSec site-to-site VPN

Protocols and WAN: TCP/IP, OSPF, BGP, VLAN, STP, DHCP, DNS, VPN, SD-WAN, LAN and WAN connectivity

Monitoring Tools: SolarWinds, Zabbix, OP5, Cisco Meraki Dashboard

ITSM and Documentation: ServiceNow, TopDesk, SX Tools, Microsoft Visio network diagrams, SOPs, run books, RCA reports, KPI dashboards

Cloud and Remote Access: Azure Virtual Desktop (AVD), Citrix, jump server VM access

Processes: ITIL Framework, Incident Management, Problem Management, Change Management, RCA, SLA Management, Capacity Planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HCL Technologies, Lucknow, India

Network Specialist / NOC Engineer | May 2022 - Present

Promoted from Network Engineer. Working in a 24x7 Global Network Operations Center (GNOC) supporting a shared enterprise network environment for global clients: CIRCOR, DCC, FMC, Cambrex, Taylor Wimpey and IAC, covering routing, switching, wireless, firewall, VPN, SD-WAN and network infrastructure maintenance.

Core Network Operations (All Client Environments)

- Provide 24x7 network infrastructure support across 50+ multi-site enterprise locations, restoring service with minimum business impact.
- Perform advanced Layer 2 and Layer 3 troubleshooting across Cisco routing and switching, wireless, VPN and SD-WAN, including BGP, OSPF, VLAN, STP, DHCP and DNS issues.
- Configure and troubleshoot Cisco switches, routers, Meraki devices, Cisco WLC and access points; isolate site connectivity, packet loss, latency and performance issues.
- Execute network configuration changes, firmware upgrades, device replacements and infrastructure maintenance with pre-change and post-change validation.
- Monitor network infrastructure proactively using SolarWinds, Zabbix, OP5 and Meraki Dashboard for fault identification, capacity planning, and availability management.

- Lead major incident bridges with L1, L2 and L3 teams, vendors and client stakeholders; drive RCA and preventive actions; manage tickets and changes in ServiceNow, TopDesk and SX Tools.
- Maintain Microsoft Visio network diagrams, IP addressing records, SOPs and run books; publish KPI reports for client reviews and mentor junior engineers on troubleshooting methodology.

Client Project Contributions

- **CIRCOR, Enterprise Network Operations:** Deliver 24x7 support across enterprise sites with advanced Layer 2 and Layer 3 troubleshooting on Cisco routing and switching, wireless, VPN and SD-WAN, including BGP, OSPF, VLAN, STP, DHCP and DNS fault isolation, configuration changes, firmware upgrades and monitoring through SolarWinds, Zabbix, OP5 and Meraki Dashboard.
- **DCC, Enterprise Network Operations:** Manage and troubleshoot enterprise Cisco routing and switching infrastructure; resolve VLAN, STP, DHCP, DNS, OSPF and BGP issues, support VPN and SD-WAN site connectivity, and deliver configuration changes, device upgrades and planned maintenance.
- **FMC, Enterprise Network Operations:** Support routing, switching, wireless, firewall, VPN and SD-WAN infrastructure; perform advanced Layer 2 and Layer 3 fault isolation on routing, VLAN, DHCP and DNS, plus configuration changes, firmware upgrades and network validation.
- **Cambrex, Enterprise Network Operations:** Provide multi-site network support covering Cisco routing and switching, wireless, VPN and SD-WAN connectivity; troubleshoot routing, VLAN, STP, DHCP and DNS issues and handle device configuration, upgrades and availability monitoring.
- **Taylor Wimpey, Enterprise Network Operations:** Provide hands-on support for enterprise routing, switching and site connectivity; troubleshoot VLAN, DHCP, DNS and routing issues and deliver configuration changes, device upgrades, maintenance and fault isolation across locations.
- **IAC, Fortinet and Network Security Operations:** Own hands-on FortiGate support covering firewall policies, NAT, routing and traffic-flow troubleshooting; resolve IPSec site-to-site VPN and inter-site connectivity issues; use Forti Manager and Forti Analyzer for centralized policy management, log analysis and security event monitoring; deliver Fortinet configuration changes, maintenance and firmware upgrades with post-implementation validation.

Core Technology Environment: Cisco, Cisco Meraki, FortiGate, FortiManager, FortiAnalyzer, Cisco WLC, Routing and Switching, SD-WAN, VPN, BGP, OSPF, VLAN, STP, DHCP, DNS, SolarWinds, Zabbix, OP5

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced repeat network incidents by 40% through structured RCA and preventive-action implementation.
- Improved cross-team resolution times by 30% by streamlining communication between L1, L2 and L3 teams during major incidents.
- Supported network operations across 50+ multi-site locations for 6+ global clients with zero major SLA breaches.
- Recognized for mentoring junior engineers, improving troubleshooting consistency and reducing escalations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer Application (BCA)

Sacred Heart Degree College, Lucknow, India | 2018 - 2021

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco CCNA, Networking, Routing and Switching, Wireless Essentials (Course Completion)
- Fortinet FCF, Technical Introduction to Cybersecurity 1.0
- Fortinet FCF, Introduction to the Threat Landscape 2.0

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English, Hindi

Strengths: Multi-vendor troubleshooting across Cisco, HP, Dell, Ruckus, FortiGate and Palo Alto platforms; cross-functional collaboration with global technical teams, vendors and client stakeholders; continuous improvement focused on RCA, preventive action and operational reliability.